

beater. Family deaths were frequent—only 5 of Gustav’s 13 siblings survived childhood. But his father made money and nurtured social and cultural aspirations. When Gustav displayed precocious talent at the piano, playing an instrument discovered in a loft, his parents paid for him to take lessons. He picked up his wider musical education by listening to military bands, barrel organs in the street, and folk songs sung by servants—all would find their place in his mature compositions.



CONDUCTOR'S BATON

This ivory, ebony, and tortoiseshell baton was presented to Mahler in 1901 by Archduke Franz Ferdinand. A dedication plaque in the center reads: “To his beloved composer Gustav Mahler.”

